

ISMAIL BENNANI

Finance & Data Analytics Candidate | Accounting Minor | Financial Analysis, Reporting Automation & Business Intelligence

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Finance and Data Analytics student at Augustana College (GPA: 3.7) with hands-on experience in accounting operations, tax preparation, financial analysis, and reporting automation. Proven ability to turn financial data into actionable insights using Excel, Power BI, R, Python, and SQL — with a track record of measurable impact across business, operations, and analytics roles.

EDUCATION

Augustana College, Rock Island, IL

Bachelor of Arts in Data Analytics and Finance; Minor in Accounting | Expected May 2027 | GPA: 3.7

Finance & Accounting: Financial Management, Security Analysis & Portfolio Management, Money and Banking, Accounting Fundamentals, Intermediate Accounting I & II

Analytics & Technical: Applied Business Analytics, Data Engineering, Data Mining, Introduction to Data Analysis, Python, Business Statistics, Applied Business Statistics

Business: Marketing, Organizational Behavior

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Finance & Accounting Operations Specialist

Augustana College - Business Office | Rock Island, IL | May 2026 - Present

- Process and reconcile 50+ weekly journal entries, P-Card transactions, and invoices, ensuring accurate financial reporting across institutional accounts.
- Identified and resolved documentation discrepancies in accounts payable workflows, improving recordkeeping accuracy and audit readiness across a 7+ person finance team.
- Streamlined expense tracking and invoice verification processes, contributing to faster approval cycles and cleaner financial data for institutional reporting.

Tax Associate

H&R Block | Moline, IL | Nov 2025 - Apr 2026

- Prepared and reviewed 50-100 individual federal and state tax returns in full compliance with IRS standards, deductions, and filing requirements.
- Conducted thorough review of client financial documents — W-2s, 1099s, and income records — ensuring accuracy and completeness before submission.
- Managed sensitive client data with full discretion in a fast-paced, deadline-driven environment serving a diverse base of individual filers.

Operations & Financial Analyst Intern

Laboralim | Casablanca, Morocco | Jun 2025 - Sep 2025

- Performed post-trade financial analysis, reconciliations, and budget variance reviews, helping identify cost-saving opportunities of approximately 2-3%.
- Automated Excel and Power BI reporting workflows, improving reporting accuracy by 15% and saving 10+ hours of manual work per month.
- Partnered with finance and operations teams to resolve budget variances and reduce approval times by 10-15% through clearer KPI tracking.

ANALYTICS & FINANCE PROJECTS

- **Investment Portfolio & Risk Analysis - R:** Analyzed monthly returns for MSFT, AGG, XLK, and VOO against the S&P 500; calculated beta, volatility, risk-return metrics, and Sharpe-like ratios to recommend an optimal allocation strategy.
- **Premier League Performance Analytics - R:** Cleaned and analyzed league, team, and player datasets using dplyr and ggplot2; built regression model to quantify how goal difference predicts team points.
- **Cash Reserve & Liquidity Forecasting Model - Excel:** Simulated T+1/T+2 settlement cycles, reserve targets, and cash-flow scenarios; improved simulated operational capital efficiency by 18%.
- **Solitaire Game Development - Python:** Designed a fully playable Solitaire game using OOP, modular functions, and rule-based logic; implemented core gameplay mechanics and debugging workflows.

LEADERSHIP

Student-Athlete, Captain — Augustana College Soccer Team | Rock Island, IL | Sep 2023 - Present

- Balanced 20+ weekly athletic hours with a full finance, accounting, and analytics course load while leading 25+ teammates and fostering discipline, communication, and team accountability.

SKILLS

Technical & Analytics: Excel, Power BI, SQL, Python, R, VBA, Microsoft SQL Server, ggplot2, tidyverse, Data Visualization, Data Cleaning, Microsoft Office, Google Analytics

Finance & Accounting: Financial Analysis, Financial Modeling, Forecasting, Budgeting, KPI Tracking, Variance Analysis, Reconciliation, Accounts Payable, Tax Preparation, Portfolio Analysis, Risk Management, Cash Flow Analysis

Business: Business Intelligence, Reporting Automation, Client Communication, Problem Solving, Team Leadership, Presentation Skills

Languages: English, French, Arabic, Spanish